Document: Poland, Italy lead resistance to ETS review

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By Ben Makuch · Nov 6, 2026, 11:38 AM · View in your browser

Poland and Italy are leading efforts to weaken the EU executive’s revision of the carbon pricing regime, according to an internal document from the Council of the European Union obtained by POLITICO .

Key to their demands is weakening proposed conditionalities within the Emissions Trading System review that asks industry to prove their decarbonization plans before being given access to free carbon allowances.

The two countries have led a gang of ETS-skeptics in the Council of the EU since March and have made similar criticisms of the EU’s landmark climate policy.

“Free allocation should remain a carbon leakage protection measure and should not be transformed into an investment-support instrument,” the Polish delegation comments in the 752-page document, adding: “Industrial decarbonisation should instead be supported through dedicated instruments, such as the Innovation Fund, Modernisation Fund and Industrial Decarbonisation Bank, while free allocation should retain its separate protective function.”

For its part, Italy asks that part of a proposed “Invest in EU decarbonization plan” be outright deleted. France backs the resistance to investment conditionalities, but says they “nevertheless open to alternative proposals on that matter.”

In public, Germany has cut a much more supportive tone of the European Commission’s July review and in the document reminds other countries they “generally welcome the Commission’s proposal as a key building block for the 2040 climate target” but it too has “reservations” on conditionalities.

The Irish Presidency has set a December deadline for finding a compromise inside the Council, with plans for a potential interinstitutional negotiation by the first or second quarter of 2027.

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